

TOPIC 1: SPEECH WORK

1. Introduction to Speech and Organs of Speech

Speech is the expression of thoughts and feelings through spoken words. The organs of speech help us produce sounds. Main organs include: lips, teeth, tongue, palate (hard and soft), alveolar ridge, vocal cords, and lungs (which provide air).

2. Pure Vowel Sounds (Monophthongs)

Pure vowels (monophthongs) are single vowel sounds that do not glide. English has several pure vowels. Examples practised in this term:

- /i:/ – long sound as in *see, meet, tea, key*
- /ɪ/ – short sound as in *sit, bit, fish, women*
- /e/ – as in *bed, pen, head, many*
- /æ/ – as in *cat, man, apple, black*
- /ɑ:/ – long sound as in *car, father, hard, calm*
- /ɒ/ – as in *hot, pot, dog, what* (often written /ɔ/)
- /ɔ:/ – long sound as in *door, more, law, talk*

3. Practice Tips

Listen carefully to correct models; practise minimal pairs (e.g. ship/sheep, bed/bad); watch mouth shape and tongue position; read aloud slowly and clearly.

4. Summary

Clear speech depends on using the organs of speech correctly and producing pure vowel sounds accurately. Regular practice improves pronunciation.

End of Topic 1